



MyGurukul

SACRED WISDOM — SATURDAY, FEBRUARY 14, 2026



SACRED TEXT

श्रुतिं स्मृतिं च
यदा विदुः श्रुतिं
तदा श्रुतिं स्मृतिं च
तदा श्रुतिं स्मृतिं च

— Tantravārttika, Chapter 2, Verse 1

GURU'S INTERPRETATION

It poses a fundamental question: are we examining the practical application of rituals, or are we discussing how external traditions and Smritis (remembered traditions) might be superseded? The core principle articulated is that when a conflict arises between what is directly stated in the revealed scriptures (Shruti) and what is prescribed in the Smritis, the Shruti, the direct revelation, takes precedence.

Think of Shruti as the direct voice of the divine, the unchanging truth, while Smriti represents the interpretations and applications of that truth through generations. The verse emphasizes that as long as there is a single instance where the Shruti prescribes one action and the Smriti suggests another, the path of the Shruti should be followed.

This principle is not just about ritualistic actions; it speaks to a deeper spiritual truth. In your own life, you may encounter situations where your intuition, your inner knowing (akin to Shruti), clashes with societal norms, ingrained habits, or advice from others (akin to Smriti). The Tantravārttika encourages you to prioritize that inner voice, that direct connection to truth, over external pressures or conventions. It's about discerning between what is authentically aligned with your soul's purpose and what is merely a conditioned response or a borrowed belief.

This isn't to dismiss tradition entirely. Smritis can be valuable guides, offering wisdom distilled from experience. However, the Tantravārttika reminds you to critically evaluate these traditions, holding them up to the light of your own inner truth. Are they serving your highest good, or are they holding you back from expressing your authentic self? The path of spiritual growth often involves questioning and re-evaluating inherited beliefs and practices, ensuring they resonate with your present understanding and spiritual journey. Trust in your ability to discern truth, and let that inner compass guide your actions.

REFLECTION FOR TODAY

What inherited beliefs or practices in your life might be Smritis that no longer align with your Shruti, your inner truth, and how can you gently begin to realign with your authentic self?